Clinical Practice Guideline

Charting of Nutritional Supplements

Scope

Site	Service/Department/Unit	Disciplines
SCGOPHCG	Organisation wide	Allied Health, Nursing, Pharmacy

Introduction

Nutritional supplements include a variety of products which are used to address nutritional issues in the clinical setting. These may be suitable for oral intake, enteral feeding or both. The most common nutritional products are oral nutritional supplements which are multi-nutrient liquid, semi-solid or powder products that provide macronutrients and micronutrients with the aim of increasing nutritional intake. Other products addressing nutritional issues which may be indicated in the clinical setting include oils such as Medium Chain Triglycerides. This procedure has been developed to authorise charting of nutritional supplements by Dietitians on the Western Australian Hospital Medication Chart (WA HMC).

Definitions

WA HMC	Western Australian Hospital Medication Chart
Oral Nutrition Supplement	Oral Nutrition supplements are multi nutrient liquid, semi-solid or powder products that provide macronutrients and micronutrients with the aim of increasing nutritional intake

Key Principles

1.0 Charting of a Nutritional Supplement

1.1 Indications for Ordering of Nutritional Supplements

- Malnutrition
- Inadequate nutritional intake as assessed by the Dietitian
- Disease specific indicators for medical nutrition therapy (e.g., critically ill, cancer)
- Increased/specialised nutritional requirements (e.g., dialysis, surgical)
- Impaired ability to absorb nutrients (e.g., inflammatory bowel disease, intestinal failure)
- Impaired ability to ingest nutrients (e.g., oesophageal tumours, neurological disorders)
- Patients with swallowing disorders identified by Speech pathology who require nutrition support.

1.2 Responsibilities

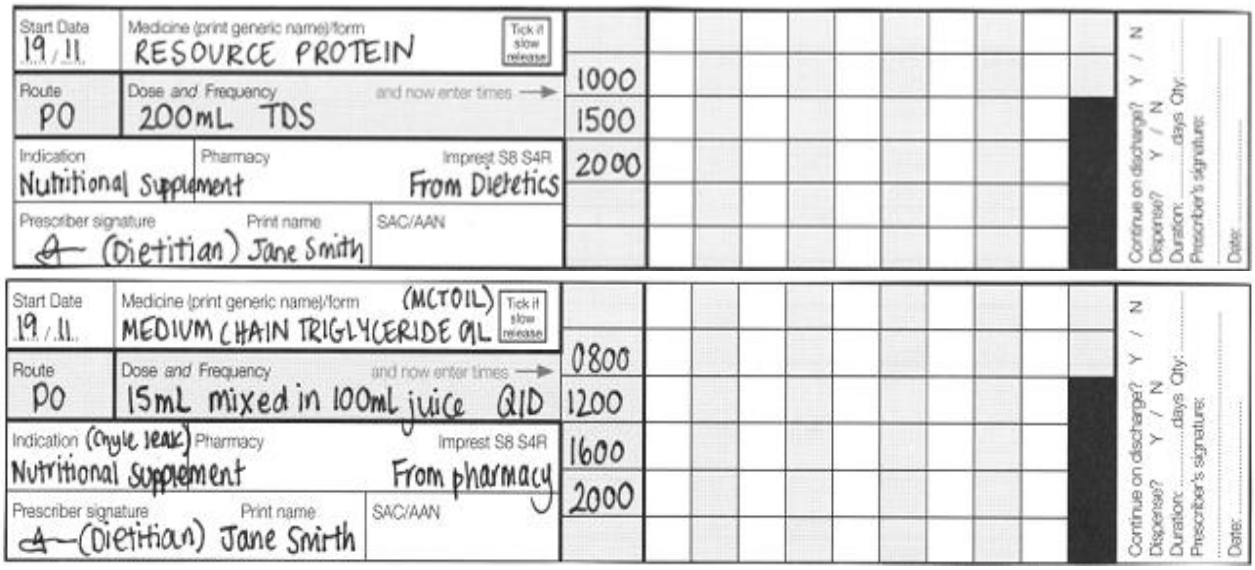
- The Dietitian is responsible for:
  - the ordering of ONS prescription on the WA HMC
  - checking the WA HMC for transcribing errors of nutritional supplement orders at every review (e.g., when charts are re-written)

- The Nurse is responsible for:
  - the delivery of the prescribed nutritional supplement
  - the recording of administration of the nutritional supplement on the WA HMC

1.3 Charting of Nutritional Supplements on the WA HMC

- All orders must be written legibly in black ink
- A separate order is required for each nutritional supplement

Figure 1: Examples of charting for nutritional supplements at SCGOPHCG



- **Medication name**:
  The medication (nutritional supplement) name must clearly state the full name of the nutritional supplement and flavour, when applicable
- **Route**
  Charted as per oral (PO), nasogastric (NG), nasojejunal (NJ), percutaneous endoscopic gastrostomy (PEG) or percutaneous endoscopic jejunostomy (PEJ)
- **Dose:**
  Nutritional supplement dose to be charted on the WA HMC by the Dietitian
  Must be written in millilitres (mL)
- **Frequency:**
  Both the frequency and administration time(s) must be entered and contain the acceptable frequency abbreviations. ***Refer to Table 1***. Administration times should be entered using the 24hour clock.

Table 1: Recommended Administration Times (guideline only)					
Daily	Daily	1000			
Morning	Mane	0800			
Night	Nocte	1800 or 2200			
Twice daily	BD	1000	1400		
Three times daily	TDS	1000	1400	2000	
Four times daily	QID	0600	1200	1800	2200

- **Indication:**
  Must state “Nutritional Supplement”
- **Pharmacy:**
  Must state “From Dietetics”, except products such as medium chain triglyceride oil which are supplied by pharmacy

- **Prescriber Signature and Name:**
  Must include the Dietitian’s printed name and signature, followed by “Dietitian”

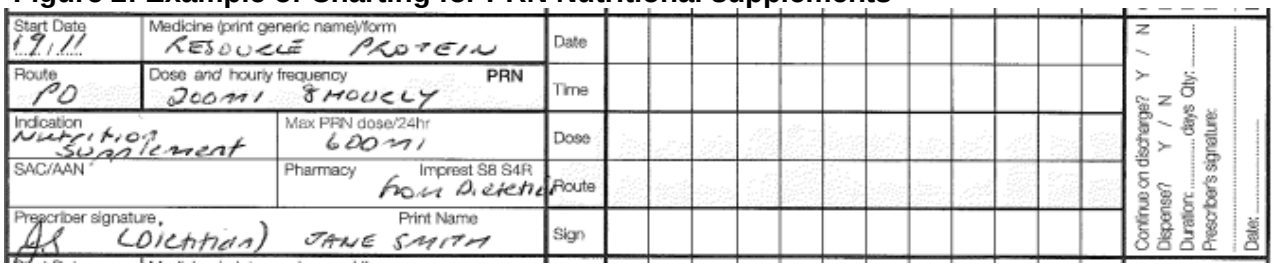
- **Stock:**
  Stock is maintained via ward imprest, additional stock if required will be ordered via the ward Dietitian.

2.0 As required "PRN" orders for Nutritional Supplements

To order a nutritional supplement PRN the Dietitian must have the following complete:

- Start date of the order
- Generic medicine name
- Route of administration
- Dose and hourly frequency (PRN alone **is not** sufficient)
- Indication and maximum daily dose (e.g. Maximum dose in 24hrs)
- Dietitian's signature, printed name and contact details

Figure 2: Example of Charting for PRN Nutritional supplements

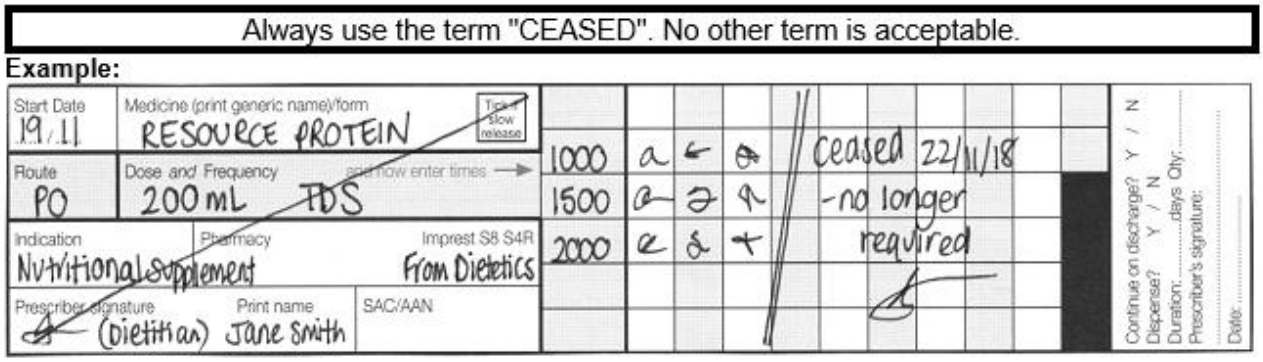


3.0 Ceasing orders of Nutritional Supplements

To cease the nutritional supplement order:

- The original order must not be removed or obscured
- The Dietitian must draw a clear diagonal line through the order and two diagonal lines through the administration record section, taking care that the line does not cross over to other orders
- The Dietitian must write the reason for changing the order (i.e. cease and the reason for example: no longer required, written in error, increased dose, alternative product charted etc.), the date and their initials in the administration record section
- When an order needs to be changed, the Dietitian must not write over the original order. The original order must be ceased and a new order written
- Only use accepted abbreviations. Chemical abbreviations must not be used.

Figure 3: Ceasing Nutritional Supplements



4.0 After Hours

In the after-hours setting, medical staff can chart nutritional supplements based on clinical judgment in relation to need for initiation or continuation. Please note Sustagen® is not available at ward level at SCGH, however it is available at ward level at OPH . Please check product details for any known allergens prior to charting.

Compliance, monitoring and evaluation

Prior to authority to write on the WA HMC Dietitians will be required to complete the National Standard Medication Chart course online. This will be completed with every new release of the education package and will be recorded in the Nutrition and Dietetics department mandatory training log. Compliance with this guideline will be audited yearly by the Nutrition and Dietetics department. In addition, compliance with this procedure (competency) will be assessed as part of the credentialing process for all clinical staff in the Dietetics and Nutrition department.

Related Documents

Quality Improvement and Change Management Unit (2022) *Guidelines for the WA Hospital Medication Chart (WA HMC).* Department of Health. Retrieved 01/05/23

Quality Improvement and Change Management Unit (2022) *Guidelines for the WA Hospital Medication Chart (WA HMC).* Department of Health. Retrieved 01/05/23

Authorisation & Version Control

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Applicable Standards					

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Document Version Control

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12/2016	1	Dietetics and Nutrition	
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For full details regarding, development, review, consultation, approval, endorsement - contact the Policy Officer for the submission form

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